ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 01

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Tuna populations in the oceans have declined sharply mainly because of —

(A) Excess rainfall over the oceans
(B) The spread of coastal forests
(C) Over-fishing by commercial fleets
(D) Use of solar energy by fishing boats

> **Ans: (C)** Commercial over-fishing took more fish than nature could regenerate.

(ii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Battle of Plassey
2. Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate
3. Coronation of Chhatrapati Shivaji at Raigad
4. Battle of Talikota

(A) 2, 4, 3, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 2, 3, 4, 1 (D) 2, 4, 1, 3

> **Ans: (A)** Correct order: Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate (1192) → Battle of Talikota (1565) → Coronation of Chhatrapati Shivaji at Raigad (1674) → Battle of Plassey (1757)

(iii) Which Delhi Sultan shifted the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad?

(A) Ala-ud-din Khilji
(B) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(C) Ibrahim Lodi
(D) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

> **Ans: (D)** Muhammad bin Tughlaq moved the capital to Daulatabad (then Devagiri); the plan failed.

(iv) Identify the correct match.

(A) Battle of Haldighati – 1526
(B) Battle of Haldighati – 1576
(C) Battle of Haldighati – 1556
(D) Battle of Haldighati – 1599

> **Ans: (B)** Maharana Pratap faced the Mughals at Haldighati in 1576.

(v) Which weapon did Chhatrapati Shivaji use to kill the Bijapur general Afzal Khan?

(A) A long spear
(B) Wagh nakh (tiger's claw)
(C) A bow and arrow
(D) A cannon

> **Ans: (B)** The meeting took place at the foot of Pratapgad.

(vi) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.
In the Maratha revenue system, an additional levy of 10 per cent over and above chauth was called .....

(A) Jizya (B) Mansab (C) Kharaj (D) Sardeshmukhi

> **Ans: (D)** Chauth was 25% and sardeshmukhi a further 10%.

(vii) The cartaz system, under which ships in the Arabian Sea had to buy permits or be seized, was introduced by the —

(A) Portuguese (B) Dutch (C) French (D) English

> **Ans: (A)** The Portuguese forced Indian ships to buy the cartaz.

(viii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): The Doctrine of Lapse became a tool for expanding British territory in India.
Reason (R): Under the Doctrine of Lapse, a princely state could be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R correctly explains A: adoption was disregarded and states were annexed.

(ix) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: The Santhal Rebellion (1855–56) was led by the brothers Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu.
Statement II: The Indigo Revolt (1859–62) took place in the Chota Nagpur region.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** The Indigo Revolt took place in northern Bengal; Chota Nagpur was the region of the Kol Uprising.

(x) Universal adult franchise is provided under which Article of the Indian Constitution?

(A) Article 21 (B) Article 324 (C) Article 326 (D) Article 356

> **Ans: (C)** Article 326 gives the right to vote to every adult citizen (18+). Article 324 deals with the Election Commission.

(xi) In the First-Past-the-Post system, the winning candidate is the one who —

(A) gets more than 50 per cent of the votes
(B) is nominated by the President
(C) belongs to the largest party in the Rajya Sabha
(D) gets the highest number of votes, even without a majority

> **Ans: (D)** A plurality, not a majority, is enough.

(xii) A Money Bill can be introduced only in the —

(A) Rajya Sabha (B) Supreme Court
(C) Lok Sabha (D) Either House as the Speaker decides

> **Ans: (C)** Money Bills originate only in the Lok Sabha and need the President's prior recommendation.

(xiii) The Council of Ministers at the Union level is collectively responsible to the —

(A) Rajya Sabha (B) Lok Sabha
(C) Supreme Court (D) Election Commission

> **Ans: (B)** The Prime Minister and Council of Ministers must enjoy the confidence of the Lok Sabha.

(xiv) A farmer buys a tractor for ploughing his fields. In terms of the factors of production, the tractor is part of his —

(A) Capital (B) Land
(C) Labour (D) Entrepreneurship

> **Ans: (A)** Machinery and equipment are durable assets, i.e. capital.

(xv) The International Solar Alliance was launched in 2015 by India and —

(A) France (B) Germany (C) Japan (D) Russia

> **Ans: (A)** The ISA is a coalition of sunshine-rich countries.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Explain the term 'natural resource curse'.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Regions rich in natural resources may show slower economic growth/development (paradox of plenty) — 1 mark
> - Because the economy does not build industries that convert raw resources into higher-value products — 1 mark

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2.(B) Distinguish between restoration and regeneration.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Restoration — returning something to its original healthy state after damage — 1 mark
> - Regeneration — Nature's ability to create new life and conditions for thriving; goes beyond restoration — 1 mark

3. State any two functions of the Election Commission of India.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Sets election dates / conducts elections to Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, State Assemblies and the offices of President and Vice President
> - Registers political parties
> - Enforces the Model Code of Conduct
> - Oversees the entire electoral process (any two, 1 mark each)

4.(A) What was the Doctrine of Lapse? Mention one result of this policy.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A princely state would be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir; the Hindu tradition of adoption was disregarded — 1 mark
> - Result: many states were annexed / it contributed to the Rebellion of 1857 — 1 mark

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4.(B) Explain the Subsidiary Alliance in two points.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A British Resident was stationed at the Indian ruler's court
> - The ruler had to maintain British troops at his own expense and conduct foreign relations only through the British (1 mark each)

5. Name any two sources from which a business can raise capital.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Personal savings
> - Family and friends
> - Bank loans
> - Stock market (shares) (any two, 1 mark each)

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three features of the iqta system under the Delhi Sultanate.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Territories were assigned to nobles (iqtadars) to collect taxes
- After meeting expenses, the surplus went to the Sultan's treasury, mainly to maintain the army
- It created a network of local administrators loyal to the centre
- The posts were not hereditary

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6.(B) Explain any three features of the Mansabdari system of the Mughals.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Officers (mansabdars) were graded by mansab (rank), as recorded in the Ain-i-Akbari
- Each had to maintain a fixed number of horses, elephants, camels and troops for the state
- An army could be raised at short notice without a permanent central army; regular inspections ensured compliance
- Mansabdars were usually paid through land assignments (jagirs) and so were also called jagirdars

7.(A) Describe any three features of Shivaji's civil administration.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Relatively centralised administration with the Ashta Pradhana Mandala (council of eight ministers)
- Hereditary posts and land assignments were abolished; every official was paid a salary from the treasury
- Officials were transferred periodically so that none became too powerful
- Pensions for soldiers' widows and posts for their sons; officials told not to oppress subjects

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7.(B) Describe any three contributions of Ahilyabai Holkar.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Governed the Holkar kingdom around Indore wisely for thirty years and cared for common people
- Built and restored hundreds of temples, ghats, wells and roads from Kedarnath to Rameswaram
- Rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath temple at Varanasi and the Somnath temple in Gujarat
- Promoted the Maheshwar weaving industry in Madhya Pradesh

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain any five causes of the Great Rebellion of 1857.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Most sepoys came from farming families hurt by British land-revenue policies
- Rumours that the new rifle cartridges were greased with cow and pig fat offended Hindu and Muslim sepoys
- Earlier warning — the Vellore Mutiny (1806) over uniform rules violating religious practice
- Annexations such as the Doctrine of Lapse/Awadh angered rulers and their followers
- Discontent over Mangal Pandey's execution at Barrackpore
- Heavy taxes, loss of traditional power and foreign cultural values

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8.(B) Explain any five ways in which British rule harmed the Indian economy.

> **Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):**
> - Heavy duties on Indian textiles in Britain, while British cloth entered India at low duty — weavers ruined
> - Artisans forced back to over-taxed agriculture; similar decline of iron, steel and paper
> - India became a supplier of raw materials and a market for British goods
> - Railways were designed to carry raw materials to ports and were paid for from Indian taxes
> - Wealth drain — Indians financed the Company's wars, administration and officials
> - Famines (Bengal 1770–72; 1876–78) worsened by harsh revenue demands and grain exports

9. Describe five measures taken in India to ensure that universal adult franchise reaches every citizen.

> **Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):**
> - The Election Commission of India, an independent constitutional body, organises free and fair elections
> - Home voting for elderly and disabled voters (2024, for the first time)
> - Postal voting facilities
> - Braille-enabled voter cards
> - App-based requests for assistance, and wheelchairs and ramps at polling stations
> - Voter registration and awareness drives; rule that no one can vote on another's behalf

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In the 1960s, farmers in Punjab shifted to high-yielding varieties of wheat and paddy. These crops need much more water than traditional seeds, and free electricity made it easy to pump groundwater day and night. Today the water table in large parts of the state has fallen beyond about 30 metres, and nearly four-fifths of its area is classified as 'over-exploited'. The state gained food security in the short run, but the soil and water now bear the cost.

(10.1) Which new crop varieties increased the demand for water in Punjab?

> High-yielding varieties of wheat and paddy.

(10.2) What does the term 'over-exploited' mean in this passage?

> Water is being drawn from the ground faster than Nature can restore it.

(10.3) Suggest any two measures to restore Punjab's groundwater.

> Any two (1 mark each): traditional water harvesting; rejuvenating ponds and tanks; cutting wasteful use of water; processing and reusing water; shifting to crops needing less water.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Shivaji's letters to his officers were specific. Teak needed for building ships of the navy could be cut, but only after permission. Mango and jackfruit trees, however, were not to be touched at all, because they take many years to mature and the villagers tend them as they would tend their own children. He warned that any gain made by oppressing others 'perishes soon, along with the oppressor'.

(11.1) For what purpose could teak be cut, with permission?

> For building ships of the (Maratha) navy.

(11.2) Why were mango and jackfruit trees protected?

> They take many years to mature and people look after them like their children.

(11.3) What does this instruction show about Shivaji's attitude towards his subjects and natural resources?

> (1) Concern for the welfare and livelihood of subjects — officials must not oppress them; (1) wise, restrained use of resources — cutting only what was needed (stewardship).

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1956, a serious train accident took place while Lal Bahadur Shastri was the Railway Minister. Although he was not personally blamed for it, Shastri felt that a minister must take moral responsibility for whatever happens in his ministry. Prime Minister Nehru at first declined his resignation, but Shastri insisted, and it was finally accepted.

(12.1) Which ministry did Shastri head in 1956?

> The Railway Ministry.

(12.2) What kind of responsibility did Shastri accept by resigning?

> Moral responsibility.

(12.3) How does this incident reflect accountability of the Executive in a parliamentary democracy?

> (1) The Council of Ministers/ministers are answerable for the working of their ministries; (1) a minister should be ready to give up office to uphold public trust, even when not personally at fault.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Indian cotton cloth — from ultra-thin muslins to richly embossed fabrics — was in great demand across the world. Under British rule, heavy duties were placed on Indian textiles entering Britain, while British cloth entered India with minimal tariffs. Thousands of weavers lost their livelihood. In 1834, the Governor-General William Bentinck observed that the bones of the cotton weavers were bleaching the plains of India.

(13.1) Which Indian industry is described in the passage?

> The cotton textile industry.

(13.2) Who was the Governor-General of India in 1834?

> William Bentinck.

(13.3) How did British trade policy ruin this industry?

> (1) Heavy import duties shut Indian cloth out of the British market; (1) cheap British machine-made goods flooded India with low duty, so weavers lost work and were forced back to over-taxed farming.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Hampi
(II) Panipat
(III) Kudremukh iron ore mine
(IV) Digboi oil field
(V) Raniganj coal field
(VI) Raigad Fort

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Hampi located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Panipat located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kudremukh iron ore mine located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Digboi oil field located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Raniganj coal field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Raigad Fort located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Hampi — **Karnataka**
- (II) Panipat — **Haryana**
- (III) Kudremukh iron ore mine — **Karnataka**
- (IV) Digboi oil field — **Assam**
- (V) Raniganj coal field — **West Bengal**
- (VI) Raigad Fort — **Maharashtra**

